

Automate or Sink

A 30-player cooperative game for project controllers and engineers · 30 min · live in one room

WHY THIS EXISTS

Controllers and engineers at Van Oord do work that AI and automation can do for them — bonnetjes overtypen, maandafsluitingen handmatig consolideren, elke nieuwe BV vanaf nul opzetten. The gap is rarely capability ("we already have AI") and almost always mindset ("we've always done it this way"). This session is the trigger to break that habit.

WHAT IT IS

A cooperative game on a 3D Monopoly-style board, played live in one room. Five teams of six on five laptops, all in the same real-time session, projected on a host screen. Every project tile is a **real Van Oord project** — Afsluitdijk, Sofia, Borssele, Tuas Mega Port, Ain Sokhna, Aberdeen South. Each comes with one finance or engineering pain that ties to that project's reality. Players answer the question, earn or lose tokens. Buy automations at the in-game **Hub** — the benefit applies to **every team**. The game rewards cooperation, not competition.

THE GOAL — WHAT PLAYERS WALK OUT WITH

Awareness

They notice that the manual work they treated as "just how it is" is actually a choice. Every type of manual pain in the game has a real AI/automation alternative — not a hypothetical, a real tool that exists today.

One concrete action

Each player names at least one thing they will try differently next week. Not a grand strategy — a single thing. *"I'm going to look at whether the monthly close can pull from the ERP automatically."* That's enough.

PRIORITY THEMES (IN ORDER OF LEVERAGE)

- 1 Structure your knowledge.** Reusable templates, project-startup packs, single sources of truth. The biggest win at Van Oord isn't a clever AI trick — it's stopping the rebuild-from-zero pattern.
- 2 Ask AI by default.** The mindset shift: when you'd reach for Excel, open an AI assistant first. The reflex change is the lesson.
- 3 Automate your reporting.** Live dashboards instead of weekly Word reports. Self-service for PMs. Stop being the bottleneck.
- 4 Process documents with AI.** Receipts, invoices, change orders, install reports — read by AI, judged by you.
- 5 Find patterns humans can't.** Variance analysis, drift detection, scour patterns — the kind of insight that needs scale.

THE TAKE-AWAY IN ONE SENTENCE

Stop doing pointless work. Use AI to do the digging — your judgement is the value.

HOW WE KNOW IT WORKED

A week after the session, at least **two in three players** can name one specific thing they're trying differently because of the game. That's our bar. Anything above is a win, anything below means we tune the questions.

PRACTICAL

Host (big screen)	.../?mode=host
Player (per laptop)	.../?mode=player
Preview / demo	.../?mode=demo
Source	github.com/thijsjochems/van-oord-monopoly

RECOMMENDED FOLLOW-UP

- ▶ **End of session:** 30-second written capture per player — "the one thing I'll try."
- ▶ **Two weeks later:** short check-in. Did it happen? What did you learn? The check-in matters more than the survey.